WHITE PAPER · UNISIG DEEP-HOLE DRILLING MACHINE × OIL & GAS

UNISIG deep-hole drilling for Oil & Gas

Precision gundrilling and BTA drilling for long, straight, tight-tolerance holes in oilfield and aerospace parts. This paper covers what the machine does, the oil & gas parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes oil & gas buyers expect, and the documentation package.

Long-bore capability — high L/D ratios	1994	Same-week / rig-down direct
ENVELOPE	SINCE	RESPONSE

Deep Hole · Long-bore capability — high L/D ratios · gundrilling / BTA deep-hole drilling machine

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Executive summary

Machine: UNISIG Deep-Hole Drilling Machine (shop nickname: *Deep Hole*). gundrilling / BTA deep-hole drilling machine at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop.

Application: Precision gundrilling and BTA drilling for long, straight, tight-tolerance holes in oilfield and aerospace parts for Oil & Gas customers — Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service

companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

Envelope: Long-bore capability — high L/D ratios. **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features. **Traceability:** Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

Deep, straight, concentric holes are one of the hardest features to produce on any CNC platform without a purpose-built machine. Most job shops don't have one. Downhole tool bodies, valve stems with long bores, hydraulic cylinders, and any part that needs a straight bore longer than a few diameters routinely gets outsourced — or worse, made poorly on an inadequate setup. UNISIG deep-hole drilling is a genuine capability moat.

Why Deep Hole for Oil & Gas work

Oilfield hardware is full of long bores that carry pressure, and a bore that carries pressure has to be straight and round for its whole length, not just at the ends. Downhole tool bodies, mandrels, and long hydraulic components all specify bores at length-to-diameter ratios where a conventional drill will wander. Dedicated gundrilling and BTA equipment is the difference between holding that and hoping.

What this looks like on a real part

A long mandrel with a through-bore that has to stay concentric to the OD is a straightness problem disguised as a drilling problem. Drill drift doesn't announce itself — the hole starts true, wanders a fraction of a degree, and by 30 inches the wall thickness is asymmetric. If that part then sees internal pressure, the thin side governs. Gundrilling holds the line because the tool is supported by the bore it is cutting, and the high-pressure coolant keeps the chip moving out instead of packing and pushing the drill off course.

> **When this is the wrong machine**
>
> This is dedicated equipment for a dedicated problem. Shallow holes in oilfield parts get drilled on whatever machine already holds the part — routing a 3:1 hole here adds a setup and buys nothing.

Full specifications

Machine type	UNISIG deep-hole drilling center — gundrill + BTA capable
Manufacturer	UNISIG (Menomonee Falls, WI) — US-built purpose machines

Platform depth capability	From a few inches to over 65 ft (20 m) per drilled hole
Platform diameter range	Under 1 mm gundrill through ~1 m BTA-class bores
Common configurations	USC-M series combines gundrilling + BTA + up to 120 tools in one guarded machine
Reference model USC-3M	71" drill depth per side; angled holes at +30° / -15°; 63" × 78" rotating table; workpieces to 66,150 lb
Straightness control	Sub-thousandth-per-foot drift on typical setups
Concentricity	Held tighter than conventional CNC-lathe drilling can offer
Coolant strategy	High-pressure through-tool
Materials	Inconel, Super Duplex, 17-4 PH, 4140/4340, Monel, titanium

Values marked "platform" reflect the machine manufacturer's published spec range for this platform family; B&R's working spec is what we quote on this specific unit.

Who this serves in Oil & Gas

Typical buyer: Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

What's hard about oil & gas work: Chloride stress-corrosion cracking, sour service (H2S), high-cycle pressure loading, exotic superalloys, and rig-down clocks that turn every hour into money. Documentation trails required for API-adjacent work.

Typical Oil & Gas parts we produce on Deep Hole

- Downhole tool bodies with long central bores
- Frac pump plungers requiring deep coolant/lube passages
- Valve stems with long stem bores
- Hydraulic cylinders for pressure-control equipment
- Coiled-tubing tool bodies with internal passages

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Oil & Gas

Standard range: Inconel 718 (aged and annealed) · Inconel 625 · Super Duplex 2507 (UNS S32750) · Duplex 2205 · 17-4 PH (all conditions H900 to H1150) · Monel K-500 · Nitronic 50/60 · F22 · F91 · 4130/4140.

Alloy behavior is different in oilfield service. Inconel 718 in the aged condition (H900, roughly 40-45 HRC) is a different machining problem than annealed 718 — feeds, speeds, and tool geometry all shift. Super Duplex 2507 machined without cutting-temperature control develops brittle intermetallics that destroy the chloride-resistance the alloy was chosen for; a shop that shrugs when you ask about phase balance is a shop that will quietly ruin your part. 17-4 PH in Condition A machines like a well-behaved stainless; in H900 it's a different animal. Every one of these alloys we run weekly, not experimentally.

> **What "we run these weekly" means:** we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

How we machine it — our 5-step process

This is the process B&R runs on every job, oil & gas or otherwise. The specifics of feeds, speeds, and tooling shift by alloy and machine; the discipline is universal.

1. **Material verification.** Every job starts with material traceability. Heat and lot numbers documented against the mill test report. For customer-supplied material, we verify against the CofC before touching the stock.

2 **First-article layout.** Stock is measured and laid out before any cutting starts. Concentricity, roundness, and squareness of the starting material established; if the stock is out of tolerance we call the customer before wasting time on a bad blank.

3 **Roughing with process control for the alloy.** Feeds, speeds, and coolant strategy set for the specific alloy family — sharp coated carbide (or PCD for high-volume Ti Grade 5), positive rake, high-pressure through-tool coolant on 2507 and Inconel to control cutting temperature. Interrupted cuts get extra attention because they cycle heat into the workpiece.

4 **Finish pass to spec.** Finish pass with a fresh insert, controlled DOC, and measured surface-finish targets. Critical features (bore concentricity, seat grooves, sealing surfaces) are held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer.

5 **CMM verification + documentation.** Every critical dimension CMM-verified. First-article report generated. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, tell us with the RFQ and we'll be straight about what we can and can't produce in-house.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Oil & Gas

±0.0005" routine on critical sealing and mating surfaces. Bore concentricity and roundness held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer. Surface-finish targets measured with a profilometer, not estimated. For seat grooves and packing bores, finish is often the difference between a sealing part and a leak-path.

Documentation and quality workflow

Material traceability by heat and lot on every job — non-negotiable for API-adjacent work. First-article layout and CMM verification standard. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, send us the requirement with the RFQ and we'll tell you straight whether we can meet it in-house or whether you need a shop with a formal QMS registration.

Response time and emergency work

Rig-down and fleet-down work prioritized over routine production. Same-day and next-day realistic when material is on the shelf. Call (936) 291-7827 direct — say "rig-down" and the phone gets to the shop floor. For emergency work off-hours, leave a voicemail; we route emergencies.

How we compare

Compared to buying finished components from an OEM: we're faster for one-offs and low-volume runs, and we hold traceability the OEM often won't share when you're outside their warranty window. Compared to a commodity job shop: we run the alloys weekly and won't ruin your metallurgy on cutting-temperature mistakes.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request, and prints stay in-shop rather than going out to third-party vendors. Note for defense and aerospace buyers: B&R is not ITAR- or AS9100-registered, so export-controlled prints and AS9100 flow-down programs need a registered shop — we'll tell you that on the first call, not after the PO.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Frequently asked questions

8 questions covering the UNISIG deep-hole drilling platform and Oil & Gas work. Also indexed as FAQ schema for AI answer engines.

What's the max depth the UNISIG can drill?

The UNISIG platform can drill from a few inches to over 65 ft (20 m) per hole. Diameter range from under 1 mm gundrill through ~1 m BTA-class. Send us your part dimensions and we confirm feasibility.

Why can't a CNC lathe drill deep holes the same way?

Straightness and concentricity fall apart at high L/D ratios on a conventional lathe — chip evacuation, drill drift, and tool support don't scale. A purpose-built deep-hole machine keeps sub-thousandth-per-foot drift on long bores; a lathe can't.

Can the UNISIG drill angled holes?

Yes on capable USC-M configurations — reference USC-3M supports +30° / -15° angled holes with a 63" × 78" rotating table holding workpieces up to 66,150 lb.

What kind of oil & gas customers does B&R Productions work with?

Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, and subsea equipment vendors. We work with new customers regularly — first-time orders don't get worse service.

Do you handle rig-down and emergency work?

Yes. Same-day and next-day are realistic when the material is on the shelf (Inconel 718, 625, Super Duplex 2507, 17-4 PH, 4140/4340). Call (936) 291-7827 direct and say "rig-down" — the phone gets to the shop floor, not a form.

Do you machine to API 6A / API 6D tolerances?

Yes — API-adjacent tolerances are routine, and material traceability by heat and lot is standard on every job. Worth being precise about the wording, though: we machine to the tolerances and finishes those specs call for, but B&R is not an API-licensed facility. If your buyer requires parts from an API-licensed shop with a monogram, that's a different vendor. If they require parts machined to print at API-class tolerances with full traceability, that's us.

How do you keep Super Duplex 2507 from losing its chloride resistance during machining?

Controlled cutting temperature — moderate SFM, aggressive feed with sharp coated carbide, high-pressure through-tool coolant. The failure mode nobody wants (sigma-phase intermetallics forming from overheating) shows up months later in service. We run 2507 weekly — this is a process we've internalized, not a spec we're learning on your part.

Can you reverse-engineer discontinued OEM oilfield parts?

Yes — routine work. Send a worn sample and any print or spec you have. We produce the replacement with material traceability the OEM often won't share when you're outside their warranty window.

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Ready to talk about your Oil & Gas work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

Published by B&R Productions — a precision CNC machining shop in New Waverly, Texas, in business since 1994. Serving oil & gas, aerospace, defense, and industrial customers across Texas and the Gulf Coast.

Written by the B&R Productions team. Machine specs verified against manufacturer data. Alloy and process notes reflect shop practice as of 2026-01-15.

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